

Story Search

You each hold half of Marina's story. Read your own scenario carefully, then interview your partner about theirs, questions ending in a preposition. Push for real detail.

STUDENT B

YOUR SCENARIO · THE NEW APARTMENT

Marina's apartment was on the fourth floor of an old building near a park, and her landlord, Mr. Chen, warned her on day one that the heating system was unpredictable. She spent her first weekend assembling furniture and was surprised by how much she depended on YouTube tutorials to get it right.

Her next-door neighbor, Doris, an elderly woman, knocked on her door the second night with a plate of cookies, insisting on welcoming every new tenant personally. Marina was thankful for the gesture but was still adjusting to the silence of the building at night, so different from the noise of her old street in São Paulo.

During her second week, she discovered a small problem: the kitchen sink leaked whenever she used the dishwasher, and Mr. Chen took almost five days to send someone to fix it. She complained about the delay to Doris, who laughed and said it was completely normal for the building.

Slowly, Marina started relying on a nearby café for her morning coffee, and the barista, a young man named Felix, began remembering her order by the second week. She wasn't dreaming of home quite as often anymore.

PART 1

Yes / No Questions

Ask your partner about Scenario 1 (The New Job). Write the question, then write their answer.

JOB

Marina's manager introduced her to the whole design team on her first day.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Priya was new to the design studio.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Marina became responsible for the entire mobile app redesign.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Marina was still afraid of speaking up in big meetings.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

PART 2

Open Questions

Same scenario, now with Wh-questions ending in a preposition. Push for names, numbers, reasons.

JOB

Marina's manager introduced her to _____ (thing) on her first day.

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Priya insisted on _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Marina was getting used to _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

JOB

Most of the coworkers' questions were about _____ (thing).

YOUR QUESTION

THEIR ANSWER

APPENDIX

Answer Key

YES / NO QUESTIONS

Scenario 1 · 1. Did Marina's manager introduce her to the whole design team on her first day? → Yes, he did. Jonah introduced her over coffee.

Scenario 2 · 2. Did Mr. Chen warn Marina that the heating system was reliable? → No, he didn't. He warned her it was unpredictable.

Scenario 1 · 3. Was Priya new to the design studio? → No, she wasn't. She had been working there for six years.

Scenario 2 · 4. Did Marina depend on a friend to assemble her furniture? → No, she didn't. She depended on YouTube tutorials.

Scenario 1 · 5. Did Marina become responsible for the entire mobile app redesign? → No, she didn't. She was responsible for a small part of it.

Scenario 2 · 6. Did Mr. Chen fix the sink right away? → No, he didn't. He took almost five days.

Scenario 1 · 7. Was Marina still afraid of speaking up in big meetings? → Yes, she was.

Scenario 2 · 8. Is Marina dreaming of home just as often as before? → No, she isn't. She isn't dreaming of home as often anymore.

OPEN QUESTIONS

Scenario 1 · 1. Who did Marina's manager introduce her to? → The whole design team.

Scenario 2 · 2. What did Doris insist on? → Welcoming every new tenant personally.

Scenario 1 · 3. What did Priya insist on? → Showing Marina around the building.

Scenario 2 · 4. What was Marina still adjusting to? → The silence of the building at night.

Scenario 1 · 5. What was Marina getting used to? → The new software the team used.

Scenario 2 · 6. Who did Marina complain to? → Doris.

Scenario 1 · 7. What were most of the coworkers' questions about? → Food and the weather back home.

Scenario 2 · 8. What did Marina start relying on? → A nearby café.